ISSUE No.16 March 1996

Thamesmead TIMES

The Front Page

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WIN WIN CHERYL BAKER'S NEW COOKERY BOOK SEE PAGE 6

WIN WIN TICKETS FOR TRIP ON LE SHUTTLE SEE PAGE 7

WIN WIN BACKSTAGE PASSES TO SEE J.X. SEE PAGE 7

THAMESMEAD RESPONDS TO NEEDS OF YOUTH

Thamesmead has launched a Youth Scholarship scheme to ensure that young people are not barred from participating in local club activities due to lack of funds and hosted a reception for them at the Harrow Manor Way offices to give them the opportunity to voice their opinions and share their ideas.

See page 5 for report.

Thamesmead welcomes New Chairman



The Directors of Thamesmead have selected Mr. Peter Mountfield to be the new Chairman.

The appointment will be ratified on March 13 at the Company's Board Meeting, Mr. Mountfield will take office that same evening. Educated at Cambridge, Mr. Mountfield was Vice President at the World Bank in Washington until 1995 and formerly a civil servant in the Cabinet Office and HM Treasury.

Gregory Lomax, Chief Executive of Thamesmead commented "on behalf of the board of Thamesmead, I am delighted to welcome Peter Mountfield, his depth of experience both in government circles and commerce will be invaluable in driving the Company forward, I look forward to working with him."

Mr. Mountfield, is married with three sons and lives in Sevenoaks, Kent.

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NEWS FROM THE BOROUGHS

GREENWICH MILLENNIUM WILL BRING NEW LIFE TO GREENWICH, LONDON AND THE WIDE REGION! After three intensive years of hard work, Greenwich Council and its local partners have finally secured the Millennium exhibition for Greenwich in the year 2000. Council Leader Len Duvall welcomed the decision and said "We now have the prospect of renewing Greenwich in the next Millennium on a scale that will be as memorable as our heritage sites." The elaborate plans for a permanent legacy on the Peninsula site, and a series of nationwide exhibitions culminating in a major exhibition as the century turns on December 31st 1999, will bring new life to areas of Greenwich and East London north and south of the River Thames. Len Duvall added: "We will be transforming a contaminated, derelict site into one of the great attractions of the world. It will boost not just Greenwich but the whole of London. The prospect of 10,000 jobs and at least £500 million of investment will mean a bonanza for the local economy."

- **New look for Nathan Way Recycling Centre.** Changes to the site include the erection of modernised signs and kerbs, an extra grate for oncoming and outgoing vehicles (in the past there was only one to serve both purposes), upgraded containers for recycling and a new plastic 600 gallon oil recycling bank donated by Halfords. Presently the site has recycling banks for oil, bottles, cans, car batteries, paper, magazines, cardboard, textiles, scrap metal and garden waste for composting. Facilities are also available for clinical waste, sheet asbestos and CFC removal from fridges and freezers.
- **Woolwich Ferry - shut down.** The Woolwich Ferry will be closed from Saturday 16th March to Sunday 31st March 1996 for essential maintenance work. A 24 hour Information Line will be in operation whilst the Ferry is closed. Telephone 0181 854 9604.
- **Council backs homes and open space for Brook Hospital site.** Greenwich Council's Planning and Development Committee have agreed a planning brief for the Book Hospital site with top priority given to creating new homes and public open space, and preserving the site's historic buildings.
- **Help for Tenants with Disabilities.** Greenwich Council can help private tenants who are disabled and who are having problems managing everyday activities such as climbing the stairs or getting in and out of the bath. You should contact the social service office at 256 Plumstead High Street on telephone number 0181854 8888 ext. 3303 as your first port of call for help. You may then be referred for an assessment by an Occupational Therapist. If your home needs major adaptations your details will be passed to the Housing Directorate where you will be invited to apply for a disabled facilities grant.
- **Insulation Grants.** Over 60's in Greenwich are urged to apply for insulation grants before payments are reduced. Fuel bills can be cut by up to £75-£95 each year when homes are draught proofed and the loft insulated. For more information and an application form call GEAC on 0181 855 5533 or freephone 0800 512012.
- **New Safari Oasis.** The new Wild'n Wet Safari Oasis was launched by the Capital Radio Roadshow at the Waterfront Leisure Centre. Councillor Debbie Smith, chair of Leisure Services, did the honour of pronouncing the facility officially open. The Wild'n Wet Adventure Water Park in open Monday to Friday from 3pm to 8pm and at weekends from 9am until 5pm. On Sundays they run a special Family session from 6pm to 8pm where a family of up to 2 adults and 4 children can enter the pools for only £5. Tel. 0181 317 5000

Bexley LONDON BOROUGH

Bexley Council provides more help to older people. Bexley Council is providing more help to older people living in the borough. Another £237,000 has been set aside to install central heating in the Council's flats for older people and by 1998 these older tenants will all have full central heating in their homes. Information booklet on keeping warm and advice about grant from the free Winter Warmth Line: 0800 289 404.

- **Adult Education at the Thamesmead Centre.** Thamesmead residents now have the opportunity of gaining new skills and qualifications for employment at the recently open Thamesmead Centre, Yarnton Way. The centre offers a wide variety of courses including Information Technology/Word Processing. Through funding from Europe and SOLOTEC, the Centre is able to offer students a Learning for Work course which includes study skills, IT and vocational course. The Centre provides a creche and also disabled access to all classrooms. Contact Jane Vong on 0181 311 8165 for further details.
- **David Bellamy commends Bexley's environmental agenda.** World famous environmentalist David Bellamy who was one of the speakers at the Local Environmental Conference and Fair which took place on Saturday 10 February at the Civic Offices, Bexleyheath, commended Bexley on it new environmental agenda, which he described as "an amazing document". The conference was attended by over 200 people.
- **Watch your speed!** The whole of Bexley is now a speed camera enforcement zone, marking the start of the latest Council initiative to reduce the number of casualties on the boroughs roads. Bexley's equipment has been provided by the Council, but will be operated by the Police. Cameras have been installed in the following roads: Woolwich Road, Abbey Wood and Eastern Way, Thamesmead, North Cray Road, Bexley, North End Road, Erith, Bexley Road, Erith and Brook Street Erith.
- **Local Lottery Funding.** Timothy Hornsby, Chief Executive of the National Lottery Charities Board, visited Bexley on Friday 16th February 1996 at the invitation of the Council. During the day Mr. Hornsby visited the Thamesmead Family Service Unit which is receiving £275,000 of Lottery funding over three years to run a family poverty project.
- **Thamesmead East Councillor Surgeries.** Councillors Donna Briant, Ron Brierly and Chris Ball. Last Saturday of each month at Thamesmead Library, Binsey Walk, Thamesmead 11.45am - 2.45pm.
- **Volunteers for Kent Association for the Blind.** Volunteers are urgently required to support people who are blind or partially sighted and live in the Borough of Bexley. KAB offer a whole range of services and activities to the clients, including home visits, clubs, local societies and outing. Volunteers are matched with individual clients. Out of pocket expenses are paid and training is given. Kent Association for the Blind works very closely with the Bexley Visual Impairment Team in the Social Services Department. Volunteers are needed to join the next training course. Contact Christine O'Brien on 0181 303 7777 ext. 2697

Thamesmead partners Bexley in riverside cycle route

Cyclists will be delighted to look forward to Summer rides along the river due to an initiative by Sustrans, a charitable body which promotes sustainable transport, and which has been leading the Thames Cycle Route project working alongside Bexley London Borough and Thamesmead.

The route runs from the end of the existing riverside walk at Thamesbank Place on the crest of the flood defence embankment, to Riverside Golf Club.

Bexley have appointed Thamesmead to carry out the work which is already in progress and planned to be completed as soon as possible.

Thamesmead are using its' schedule contractor, Beach, to handle the construction.

Bexley's Donna Briant Stands Down

Thamesmead were sad to hear Donna Briant has decided to stand down as leader of the Labour Group for the Bexley London Borough, but was pleased that she will continue as a Councillor for Thamesmead East. Gregory Lomax the Chief Executive of Thamesmead commented on behalf of the Board and staff: "We look forward to working with Councillor Briant in the future and in the meantime wish her the very best for the future and are happy to hear the news that she is expecting a new baby, due in July of this year."

The Acting Leader of Bexley London Borough is Councillor Derek Enticknap. The Labour Group will be choosing a new Leader at the annual elections shortly.

Important notice for Greenmead residents

Thamesmead Town has arranged a constituency meeting for Greenmead residents on Tuesday, 30 April 1996 from 7pm - 9pm at Greenmead Clubroom, Lime Row, Thamesmead South. The centre will be open from 6pm in order for residents to view a small exhibition specific to the Greenmead area. Refreshments will be available free of charge before the meeting.

The Company wishes to use this opportunity to allow you to raise your concerns on general matters in the Greenmead constituency and to inform you of issues and improvements affecting your area and the Company as a whole. If you have any items you wish to put on the agenda please ring the Directors Support Unit on 0181-310-1500 ext. 392. The deadline for receipt of items for the agenda is 12 April 1996.

There will be a housing desk available at this meeting from 6.30pm. This will allow residents with individual problems to speak to a housing officer in person. Individual issues will not be allowed at the main meeting. The meeting will be attended by Mr David Shanks, the Elected Director for Greenmead and Mr Gregory Lomax, Thamesmead Town's Chief Executive.

Notes will be taken of these meetings and a report back will be made to the Board of Thamesmead Town at its next regular meeting, together with any recommendations.

PLEASE MAKE THE EFFORT TO ATTEND THESE MEETINGS – THEY ARE FOR YOUR BENEFIT.

Thamesmead Town Directors Surgeries

Broadwaters (Area 1)
Ray Hutchins;
Broadwaters Village Hall.
2nd Saturday of every month
11 am-12 noon

Waterfield (Area 2)
David Irons;
33 Waterfield Close (Home),
Every Monday evening
7.15 pm-9.15 pm.
Telephone: 0181-311 7761

Moorings (Area 3)
Ian Savill; Jubilee Centre,
Lytton Strachey Path.
Alternate Thursday evenings
7pm - 8pm.

Manorway (Area 4)
Gerry Bright; 33 Linnet Close,
Thamesmead North (Home).
Telephone: 0181 311 1946

Crossway (Area 5)
Albert Devereux;
7 Longworth Close (Home).
Daily 9am-8pm,
Telephone: 0181 244 9323

Southmere (Area 6)
Katharine Galloway (temporary cover); Binsey Walk, Patch Office
3rd Saturday of the month
11am-1pm
Telephone 0181 333 1786

Lesnes (Area 7)
Tina Anderson;
Evenlode House Patch Office
1st Saturday of every month
10am-11pm

Parkview (Area 8)
Katharine Galloway;
32 a/b Maran Way,
Telephone 0181 333 1786.
1st Saturday of the month
10.30am-12.30pm

Greenmead (Area 9)
David Shanks;
Greenmead Clubroom Lime Row,
1st Saturday each month
9am-10am
Telephone: 0181 312 1371
(Before 9.45am)

THAMESMEAD TIMES
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THAMESMEAD TOWN
HARROW MANOR WAY
THAMESMEAD SOUTH
LONDON
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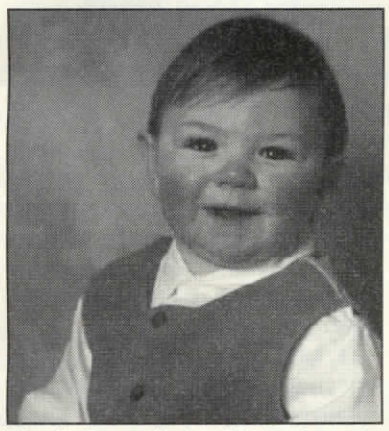
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Thamesmead

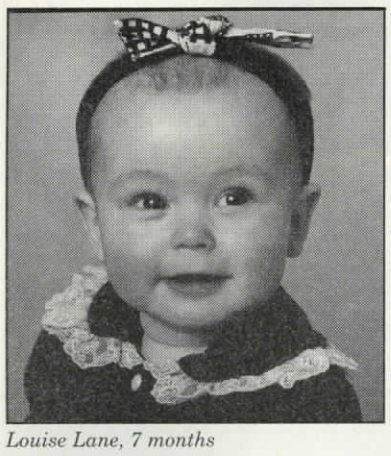
Congratulations to Greenwich and its local partners in securing the Millennium Exhibition for Greenwich in the Year 2000

SHOPPING CENTRE CHILD OF THE YEAR

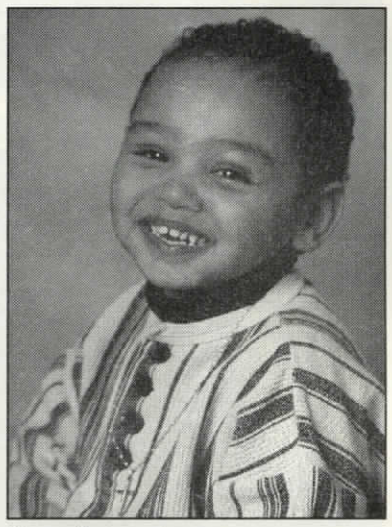
The competition has been an enormous success, Cliff the photographer, has been rushed off his feet photographing the children of Thamesmead - so much so that he didn't even have time to pop into our offices with the shots - but we collected them ourselves and so here are some of the entries:
The winners will be announced in the April issue of the Thamesmead Times!



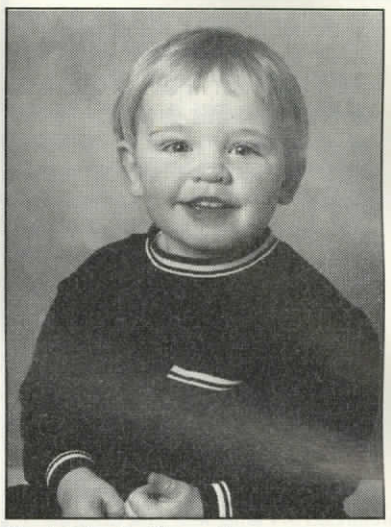
Charlie George Coulter-Liston, 9 months



Louise Lane, 7 months



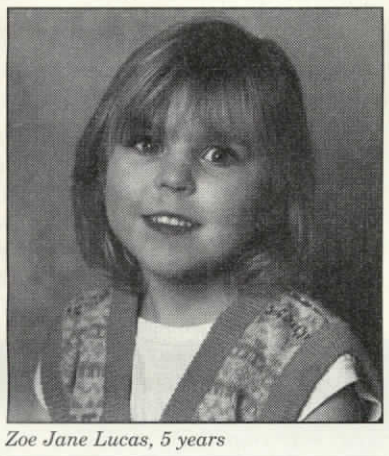
Kieron Savage, 2 years



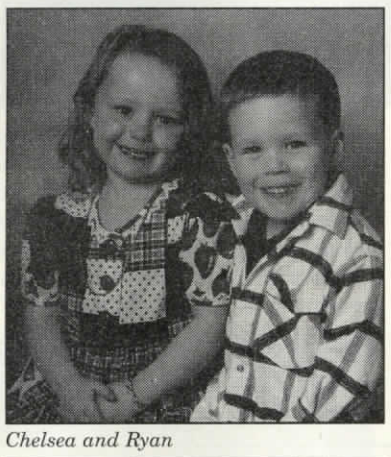
Daniel Harris, 22 months



Rebecca Guyott, 3 years



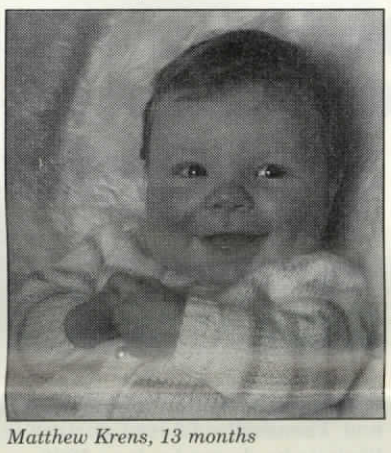
Zoe Jane Lucas, 5 years



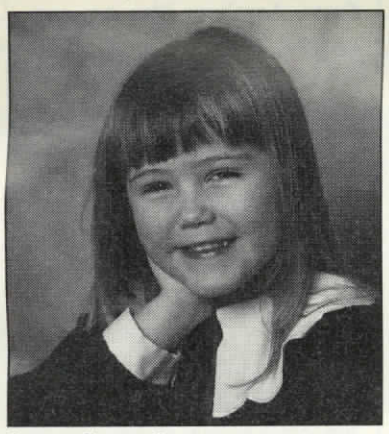
Chelsea and Ryan



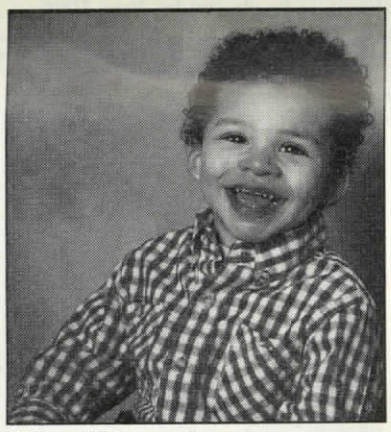
Zack Annette, 8 months



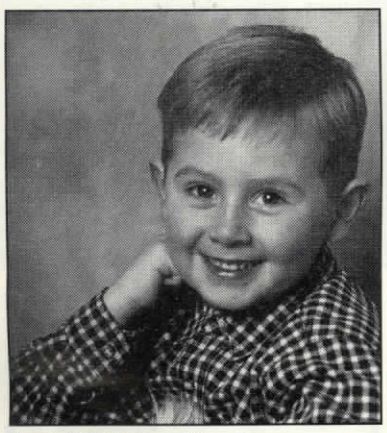
Matthew Krens, 13 months



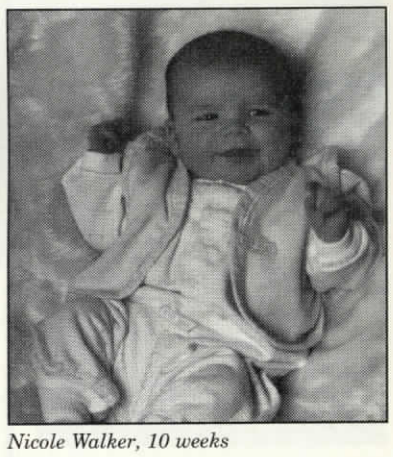
Lauren Guyott, 5 years



Callum Whitmore, 2 years



Lewis Vandercom, 4½ years



Nicole Walker, 10 weeks

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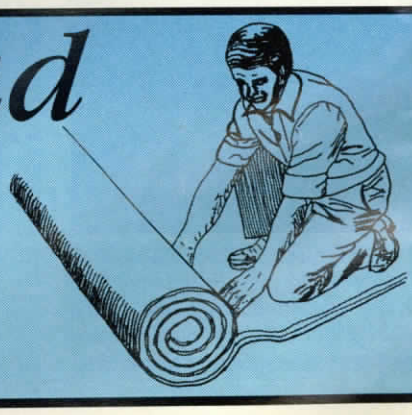
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Thamesmead

COMMENT



On behalf of all at Thamesmead I would like to welcome Mr Peter Mountfield our new Chairman. Mr Mountfield has vast experience on government issues from many years with the Civil Service in the Cabinet Office and HM Treasury and was Vice President at the World Bank in Washington until 1995.

I know that he will contribute greatly in taking Thamesmead forward to the benefit of the company and the residents of Thamesmead.

It has been an exciting few weeks with the on/off announcements regarding Greenwich and their Millennium bid, so it was good news when Virginia Bottomley formally announced in Parliament that Greenwich had actually won the bid for the Millennium Festival, this will without doubt assist in the ongoing regeneration of the whole of the Thames Gateway, of which Thamesmead is a key part.

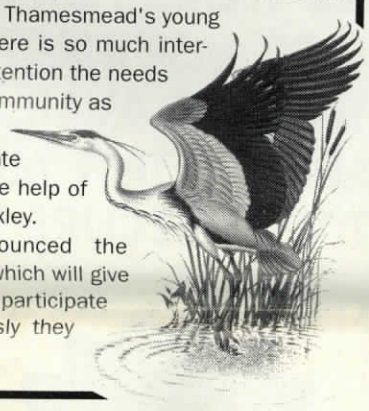
The Company is in the process of looking at lots of ideas for Thamesmead to celebrate the Millennium which we hope to do with the whole community: watch this space!

I am delighted to say that the Constituency meetings are generating interest and gaining so much resident input from the relevant areas. The Thamesmead Times will be reporting on acting taken resulting from the meetings.

With the elections coming up in Lesnes, Broadwaters, Manorway and Southmere, we decided to invite prospective candidates to two informal meetings to discuss the role of an Elected Director on the Board of Thamesmead Town. I was very pleased with the enthusiasm of the residents who attended and hopefully will be able to let you know who will be standing in the near future.

Ian Savill's (the Director for the Moorings) youth initiative was launched at the end of February with a reception for Thamesmead's young people. It is encouraging to know that there is so much interest out there in not only bringing to our attention the needs of our youth but in being involved in the community as a whole – we take their views very seriously and will endeavour to investigate and improve the facilities we offer with the help of both the boroughs and Greenwich and Bexley.

In the meantime, we have announced the Thamesmead Youth Scholarship scheme which will give 100 young people the chance to join and participate in clubs and organisations that previously they may not have been able to afford.



EVENLODE HOUSE WELCOMES NEW SECURE DOOR ENTRY SYSTEM



George Gardiner, Chairman of Age Concern Thamesmead joined Graham Lilly, Head of Thamesmead Housing Technical Services and Lester Emanuel, the Consultant for the programme to celebrate the opening of the new 'Secure Door Entry System' Dot Pain who is a resident of Evenlode House, cut the ribbon.

The system has allowed for special needs such as flashing beacons for those with impaired hearing and strategic siting of handsets for the less mobile.

Further works are to follow, with additional fencing and other security measures, as well as decoration of the staircases. Graham Lilly said "This is another step towards increasing security in the area for the benefit of our residents".

Thamesmead Delighted at Enthusiastic Response from Developers

Following an invitation to tender for the prestigious Gallions Reach Urban Village many top developers expressed an interest in partnering Thamesmead in building and promoting what they consider to be 'South East London's best riverside development site'.

Gallions Reach Urban Village will feature 2000 homes, commercial and social amenities in an inspiring environment.

Estimated to be built over 10 years, the project is to commence construction in the spring of 1997, there will be four major phases covering an area of 130 acres.

Find the right partner to build a sustainable community of such size and variety will involve two stages and Thamesmead's lead partner is likely to be chosen by June 1996.

Thamesmead Review

by Dave Irons

Since January 10, when Sir James Mellon resigned, I have been the Acting Chairman representing the company with local authorities, tenants from Kingsmead Estate in Hackney and several local projects which we are developing to improve the community and create new training and job opportunities in the Town.

I have also taken part in the selection process for the new Chairman, this was ably led by David Shanks the Director for Greenmead.

There were 106 applications in answer to our advertisements in the national press. These were whittled down to 16 which the Board studied in detail and matched against our agreed criteria and personal job specifications.

We interviewed six people, putting each candidate through a rigorous questioning and saw the three finalists once again.

I am delighted to announce that we selected Mr. Peter Mountfield who has a very varied experience and will contribute much to the Company and the residents of Thamesmead overall.

I very much look forward to working with Mr. Mountfield in the future.

THANKS TO THAMESMEAD

■ **"The Church Council and Members of the Church of the Cross, Lensbury Way are very greatful for the £3000 grant towards the cost of renewing the floor in the Church, Hall and Kitchens. The generous grant, (together with an anonymous gift), have enabled us to complete the renovation works on the building which began with the re-roofing and replacement doors and windows." Sheila Foreman.**

■ **"1st Thamesmead Guides received a generous grant of £286 towards essential camping equipment, four Sleeping bags and groundsheets, a stove and toilets - elsan, which will all be put to good use this year. The equipment has enabled several guides to take their Camp Permits this year." Mrs. D. Mills, Guide Guider.**

Focus on Thamesmead

• CONSTITUENCY MEETING NEWS. Residents raised the issue of inadequate lighting on Manor Way at the Manor Way Constituency meeting, the police officers who were present registered the information that Manor Way cycle path was now adopted and made representation to London Borough of Greenwich to improve the lighting in the area. Greenwich London Borough responded and within three weeks the lighting was repaired and 'up and running'. It is hoped that a 're-vamp' is imminent of the lighting in the underpasses under Crossway, Carlisle Road, Bentham Road and Titmuss Avenue.

• Constituency Meeting. The Parkview meeting was a lively and well attended meeting and gave rise to the discussion of many issues including security, parking, dog fouling and building improvements. Thamesmead renewed their commitment to take action on community concerns and are progressing security schemes, parking improvements in Maran Way and are putting together plans for significant external improvements for many of the buildings.

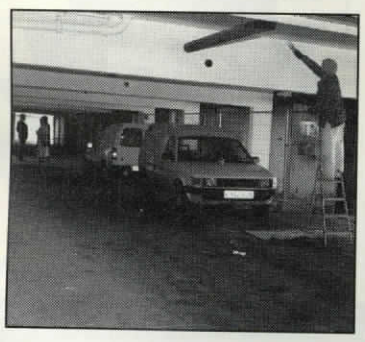


• PARKING IMPROVEMENTS. Thamesmead in partnership with Bexley London Borough are in the process of making environmental and parking improvements to Maran Way. The project should be completed by the end of April and an official opening ceremony is planned.

• NEW NURSERY FOR THAMESMEAD. Hi-Lo will be providing a new nursery for staff of Hi-Lo, employees within the Business Park and Thamesmead residents, construction is now taking place and staff being recruited. The Thamesmead Times will be speaking to Hi-Lo for more information.

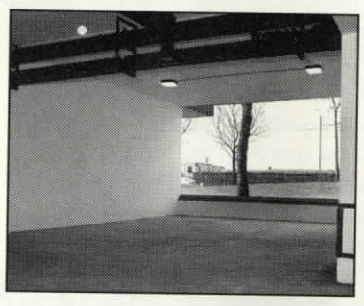
• CLUB NEWS. Everyone is delighted at the confirmation that Phil Cleary and Tony Hill have had confirmation of a six year lease on the Pyramid Club.

• Ron Brummitt and Tony Cussack hope to re-open the Limestone Club in April following redecoration.



• Phase One of Garage Improvements Completed

The 6th March saw the completion of Phase One of improvements to garages at Coralline Walk. Work began on 5th February to open up the garage fronts, the alterations will continue with refurbishment of garages, including extra security bars. Alterations to the other bas at Coralline Walk are planned for the near future.



Graham Lilly, Head of Housing Technical Services at Thamesmead, explained that the main purpose of the project was to open up the garage area by selective demolition giving a much brighter, visual aspect thus encouraging residents to use the remaining garages. There is a great need for addition, secure, off-street parking in the area and this is the first stage of what is hoped to be a continuing programme.

If the garages that now have an open look about them, are at last rented by the people for whom they were intended, i.e., the householders of Coralline Walk, then I sall do my best to get the other areas opened up.

The unused block of garages at the Yarnton Road end of the walkway have been opened. This has a key operated security gate and bars will be fitted across each garage for the new tenants peace of mind as the garages are taken up.

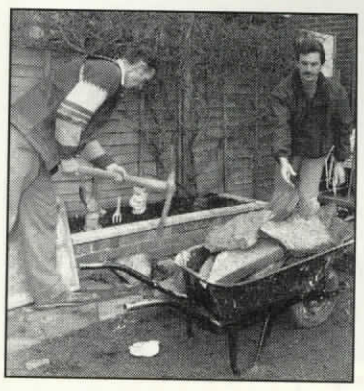
Bars will be fitted across all new garage doors for additional safety and peace of mind.

Contracts Manager: Mr T Brooker/Tommy Gillham MD
Consultants: Steven Frankham Associates – Paul Daulton
Started on 5th February 1995
Completed on 6th March 1996

• Thamesmead says 'Neigh' Mr Murphy

Thamesmead assisted the RSPCA in their investigation into a case of cruelty to horses in the area. A man, Mr Murphy, was found guilty, fined £700, given two months suspended sentence for two years and banned for life from keeping horses.

An animal was confiscated and is now being cared for by the British Horse Rescue Service.



• Urgent Response to Child's Needs

Thamesmead responded immediately when Bexley London Borough told them of young James O'Keefe's situation.

James has Downs Syndrome and needs a play area of his own – especially wen he needs to be in his buggy. The O'Keefe's have a small garden, but is has been turfed – which restricts the movement of the buggy, so Thamesmead contractors have moved in to totally pave the area with attractive paving slabs. The work will be finished by mid-March and the Thamesmead Times will follow up the story in April.

Thamesmead
Be a responsible dog owner – Clean up after your dog

OPPORTUNITIES 2000
Training for the Millennium

PETER HARRIS reports on how the launch of a new training scheme is set to brighten the future of many young people in the local area.

The Mayor of Greenwich, local MP John Austin-Walker and Sunday Times editor John Witherow were just some of the well known names which attended the official opening of 'Opportunities 2000' at the Trafalgar Tavern in the heart of Greenwich.

Throughout a most interesting morning the Thamesmead Times learnt of the exciting plans for this innovative project which begins in May of this year, having already been a great success in Chicago, USA, the city which the Greenwich Festival are working with this year.

The scheme aims to provide youth in the South East area with invaluable summer training and education, with different courses set up each year. 'Opportunities 2000' will kick off in 1996 with an Arts, Music and Leisure apprenticeship lasting six weeks. The London based organisation hopes the course will match the Chicago experience.

100 young people will be recruited from Job Centres, art and youth organisations around the borough, which bodes well for those in Thamesmead who might be interested in taking part. The proposed setting is the Royal Arsenal in Woolwich, which is an ideal location for the project providing a site where young people can enhance their image of themselves by 'creating a colourful oasis of art'. At the end of the six weeks participants should have gained accreditations and learnt a wide variety of skills.

This years scheme has already received support from major events like the Greenwich Music Maker Festival and promises to get the organisation off to a fine start.

Plans are already going ahead for courses up to the year 2000. Language workshops and residential opportunities have already been mentioned as possibilities for the years to come. At the moment it is up to people like programme manager Sade Johnson to ensure the '96 arts course gets off to a prompt and satisfactory start, as it is hoped to be the beginning of a long term scheme.

Opportunities 2000 is on Thamesmead's doorstep and should be a benefit to the areas youth who are in an ideal position to take advantage of the facilities, it is a programme which is sure to launch youth into the millennium with new skills and experience for a new vision of the future.



Thamesmead's Peter Harris meets Sunday Times Editor John Witherow

Thamesmead youth have their say!



From an initiative by Mr. Ian Savill, Director of Moorings in Thamesmead on Thursday, 29th February, Thamesmead hosted an informal reception for the young people of the area to give them an opportunity to voice their opinions.

Invitations had been personally delivered or handed out throughout the town to encourage the youth of our community to share their ideas and to enable them to say what sort of activities and opportunities they would like to see provided.

This meeting is hoped the be the first of several forums for discussion.

The young people who attended expressed a number of views which included:

- a wish for there to be something to do and somewhere to go at the weekends, when traditionally the Youth Clubs are closed
- an area dedicated to motor bike riding
- BMX tracks for the younger members of the community
- more facilities for games such as snooker and pool in the local clubs

Thamesmead are glad of the opportunity of addressing these initial points and Gregory Lomax, Chief Executive of Thamesmead gave his commitment that these would be investigated.

The Community Group will be looking at a Motor Bike site at Joyce Green, Dartford, to see how this project works. Mr. Lomax said that he was prepared to propose to the Company that funding support should be made available to such a project in Thamesmead, if a site that would be suitable to both 'bikers' and residents can be found.

The Community Group will also be looking at the other subjects raised and will be reporting back.

Meanwhile, the Company hope that the new Scholarship Scheme goes somewhere to giving the young people of Thamesmead opportunities to enjoy Thamesmead and be involved in their community.

Thamesmead launch youth scholarship scheme

100 lucky young people will soon have the opportunity of participating in many activities that they may have thought they'd never be able to afford.

As a result of Constituency meeting discussions carried out between residents and Thamesmead the Thamesmead Community Group have been carrying out an action plan contacting all local clubs and groups, pioneering a new concept for the area enabling 100 young people to receive a Scholarship for 12 months which will cover either the annual subscription of the club or group or the entry fees for the year. The only requirements are that the applicants should be 10 to 17 years of age and be resident in Thamesmead.

The activities available range from Angling and Karate, through to Riding, Dance and the Arts.

Applicants have first to decide which activity they wish to be involved in, then fill in a simple request for Scholarship form the scheme will be open to the first 100 successful applicants. Priority will be given to those applicants who are physically challenged.

The following groups are involved in the Scheme:

Thamesmead Angling Club
Waterfield Centre
Thamesmead Youth Centre
Heronsgate Youth Centre
Freestyle Karate Club
Thamesmead YMCA
1st Thamesmead Guides
3rd Thamesmead Scout Group
Thamesmead School of Dance
Riverview Riding Club
Thamesmead Arts Club
2nd Thamesmead Scout Group
St. Johns Ambulance

Application forms are available from Thamesmead's Offices at Harrow Manor Way Thamesmead South London SE2 9XH. Tel: 0181 310 1500, or alternatively from the participating groups

BIRCHMERE VIEW · THAMESMEAD SE28

BUY A 3 BED HOUSE FOR UNDER £41 PER MONTH!



Amazing but true. You could own a brand new 3 bedroom house set beside picturesque Birchmere Lake from under £41 per month – thanks to our Deal of Lifetime. Here's how it works.

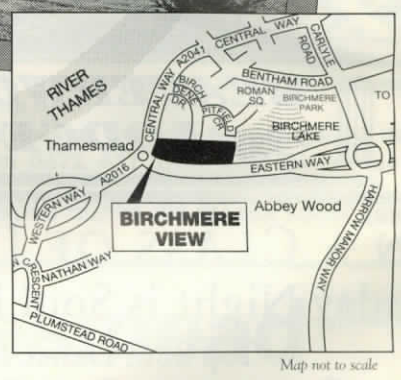
5% DEPOSIT PAID OR 100% HOME EXCHANGE

We'll pay your 5% deposit and up to £500 towards your purchase costs if you are a first time buyer. If you have a property to sell we could buy it from you for its full market value!

MORTGAGE PAID TIL '97

We pay your mortgage – up to £50,000 – until January '97. Which means if you have a joint income of £27,500 you could move now.

Make sure you visit Birchmere View this weekend to view our outstanding plans for these houses.



Map not to scale

Birchmere View, Sales Office off junction of Central Way and Eastern Way, Thamesmead, SE28.

3 bedroom houses with fitted kitchens, double glazing, central heating, landscaped front gardens and garages or private parking.
Prices from only **£71,995**.
Sales office open 10am to 6pm
Thursday to Sunday. (Mon 2pm to 6pm.)

Tel: 0181 312 1102

All offers within this advertisement are available on selected properties for a limited period only. Loans are subject to valuation and status and available to applicants aged 18 or over. Cost per month figures are based on a selling price of £71,995. Advance of 95% would be £68,395. A lenders arrangement fee of £250 and indemnity guarantee payment of £1,080 are required. Figures are based on a repayment mortgage over 25 years at a fixed rate of 2.65% **(APR 2.8%)** until 31st January 1997. Monthly repayments would be £141.10 (after MIRAS) of which Barratt pay a subsidy of £100.48 per month. After this rate reverts to lenders current variable rate (presently 7.54% **(APR 8.1%)**. Monthly payments would be £401.46 (after MIRAS). A suitable life policy would be required and assigned to lender.

BARRATT
Britain's Premier House Builder

YOUR HOME IS AT RISK IF YOU DO NOT KEEP UP REPAYMENTS ON A MORTGAGE OR ANY OTHER LOAN SECURED ON IT.

RTM and CSV Offer Media Opportunities to the Area



CSV London Media hosted a reception in February to tell local press, politicians and commerce about their training programme for radio journalism and broadcasting an their involvement with RTM.

Andrew Pendleton, the Manager of London Media spoke, as did Rodney Collins, Managing Director of RTM, Sid Burke, CSV's London Media's Training Manager and His Worshipful Mayor, Councillor Tony Moon who showed great enthusiasm for the scheme, welcoming the personal esteem and social value the project could bring to its trainees.

Shaun Spiers, MEP, attended as did representatives from Solotec Woolwich Development Agency, Woolwich College and members of the local press, current and ex-trainees.

The training courses last six months and enable trainees to learn about broadcasting while actively working on the job.

Andrew Pendelton admitted that the course seemed to offer a depth and experience of this area of media that probably could not be matched even in three years of University study of the subject, which he had undertaken.

Sammy Bell, RTM's Station Manager said: "This has been a great day for both RTM and London Media, it has cemented the link between RTM in its role as a local commercial radio station and the opportunities that London Media (CSV) offer to the areas unemployed."

Sid Burke added: "I was very pleased to have the opportunity to talk, not only about the unique training opportunity offered by our course, in conjunction with RTM, but also to introduce some of our graduates. Any training project aimed at the long-term unemployed has to be particularly proud if it succeeds in giving them skills for an important workplace, as well as pushing, pulling or prodding them into becoming effective, well motivated people!"



BEAVERWOOD LODGE

IN A CLASS OF IT'S OWN
Tuesday Night is Soul Dance Night
Top Soul Dance D.J.
Steve St John
Presents
• Atlantic Soul - Motown •
• Philiadelphia-Jazz Funk •
• Funk-Soul-Reggae-Dance •
Quality Entertainment – Tailored to the Taste of the sophisticated Over 25's
Doors Open 8.30 pm - 12 Midnight
£4 Entrance fee • Dress to Impress
Beaverwood Lodge, Beaverwood Road, Chislehurst
Enquires Tel: 0181 301 2509

CHERYL BAKER'S LOW CALORIE COOK BOOK

Jon Lucas, well known RTM presented was delighted to welcome Cheryl Baker on his morning show. Cheryl talked about her new cook book and was so down to earth and friendly, that the Thamesmead Times felt sure that her recipes would be so too.

We phoned her manager Gill and asked: "Could we have a book for one of our readers to win?". She kindly said "no problem".

If you would like to write into the Thamesmead Times giving us a reason why you'd like to receive a signed copy of Cheryl's book, we'll ask Jon Lucas to decide on the winner!



Jon Lucas picked his favourite recipe from the book for readers and here it is:

Boozy Apple Crumble

Serves 4

Per person: 165 Kcals, 3% Fat, 65% Carbohydrate, 2g NSP

500g/1¼lb cooking apples
150ml/¼ strong cider
grated zest of ½ lemon
½ tsp ground cinnamon
artificial sweetener (powder or liquid)
25g/1oz crushed cornflakes
75g/3oz brown breadcrumbs (about 3 slices)

• Preheat the oven to 190°c/375°/Gas Mark 5. Peel & core the apples and chop roughly. Place in a saucepan with the cider, lemon zest and cinnamon. Bring to the boil, then reduce to a simmer and cook for 5 minutes.

• Using a slotted spoon, transfer the apple pieces to an ovenproof dish. Taste the flavoured cider, sweeten accordingly and pour over the apple pieces.

• Mix the crushed cornflakes with the breadcrumbs and sprinkle over the apple.

• Bake for 15-20 minutes or until the topping is crisp.

• Serve with low-fat yoghurt, decorated with mint springs.

DON'T FORGET: Send in your reason for wanting Cheryl's new book and you could win a signed copy!
Send your reason to: Cheryl's Book,
Thamesmead Times,
Harrow Manor Way,
Thamesmead South,
London SE2 9XH.

HERONSGATE PRE-SCHOOL LEARNING ALLIANCE
•
We have vacancies for 3-5 year olds
Mon–Fri 9.30–11.00
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All welcome to our safe and happy group
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Penny Ball
0181-473 8629

RTM DJs present highly successful 70's charity night.



Ever wondered what top RTM Radio presenters Jon Lucas, Richard Wright, Mark Fox and Ray Bradshaw get up to in their spare time?

On Saturday 17 February 1996 these masters of the mixing desk played all the hottest Seventies tunes to a packed crowd at The Foresters Pub, Upper Wickham Lane, Welling. Nearly £600 was raised for Bexley Mencap in this sell-out party in honour of the disco decade.

Charlton FC player Colin Walsh was present, offering a signed football to the hightest bidder, along with a signed photo of the momentous occasion when Colin scored the first goal on Charlton's return to The Valley - each item raised £100 and £97 respectively.

Prizes were also on offer for the man and woman in the best 70's dress. Reflecting on the party night RTM's Jon Lucas said "it was a nostalgic trip back to the 70's with great music and loads of fun, plus we raised hundrcds of pounds for charity - what could be better!"

Dance 'till you drop at Beaverwood Lodge

Steve St. John's got soul, and he wants to share it with you! He's set up a club night especially for fans of Soul, Motown, Phili, Funk, Reggae and Dance.

Steve's Soul Dance Night is being run on a Tuesday night at Beaverwood Lodge.

Says Steve: "There's lots of clubbers out there who have children or other weekend commitments, so I felt that a Tuesday night would be perfect for them. A night of quality entertainment is what I'm offering, at realistic prices. Even the bar prices are good, certainly not your usual Club prices. Over 25s can have a brilliant night out, with great music in a comfortable environment which is easily affordable."

With over 30 years of music behind him and being a popular DJ for many football club and City events, not to forget that all the weddings, celebrations and radio experience, we are sure that Steve will give you a superb night out.

The Thamesmead Times missed the first night on Tuesday, 6th February as we were going to press, but we'll be reporting back.

RADIO rtm 103·8 FM

MONDAY - FRIDAY

06.00 RODNEY COLLINS
07.00 JON LUCAS
11.00 DELROY HAYNES
15.00 RAY BRADSHAW
19.00 SAMMY BELL (except Friday)

SATURDAYS

06.00 STEVE PERRY
07.00 KEN MURRAY
08.00 MARK FOX
10.00 RICHARD WRIGHT
14.00 PETER HAYNES
15.00 RTM SPORTS
18.00 MARK FOX
21.00 RAY BRADSHAW (SOUL SHOW)
22.00 CLIVE R
01.00 VIETNAMESE PROGRAMME
01.30 STARSOUND

SUNDAYS

07.00 RODNEY COLLINS
09.00 JON LUCAS
13.00 DELROY HAYNES
16.00 SAMMY BELL
18.00 RAY BRADSHAW (SOUL SHOW)
19.00 BEAUTIFUL GAME
21.00 JOHN KENNEDY
00.00 CLUB SHOW
01.00 AYO BADEJO
03.00 THRU THE NIGHT

EVENINGS ON RTM

MONDAYS

21.00 GRUMPY BROWN
00.00 STAR SOUND (BHANGRA SHOW)
03.00 SUPERGOLD

TUESDAY'S

21.00 TONY ANDERSON
22.00 RICHARD WRIGHT
00.30 STAR SOUND
03.00 SUPERGOLD

WEDNESDAYS

20.30 SAMMY BELL (FOLK)
21.30 THE DAY THAT CHANGED MY LIFE
22.00 TONY MONSON
00.30 STARSOUND
03.00 SUPERGOLD

THURSDAYS

21.00 WORD ON THE STREET
22.00 MARK FOX
00.30 STARSOUND
03.00 SUPERGOLD

FRIDAYS

19.00 KEN MURRAY
20.00 BRIAN ERINGA
22.00 TONY MONSON
00.00 THE GOSPEL SHOW
01.00 STARSOUND
03.00 THRU THE NIGHT

Gerry Bright's Holiday Tips
Yorkshire and the East Coast
God's County

For our holiday, we made our base the beautiful and historic City of York. We planned to visit the coast on the sunny days but should the weather not be kind, we knew that we had lots to see and do in York.

Exploring this wonderful city, is exciting and unique. You can walk around the city walls and pass the main gates into the city. Over 3 miles long, the walls were built to defend York from invaders during the period when it was the Capital of the Roman Empire and later the main centre during the Viking period.

Space only allows me to tell you of some of the wonders that you should visit. Don' miss the mighty 'Minster', the seat of the Archbishop of York and still used daily for normal Cathedral Services.

Visit the National Railway Museum and see amongst 100's of exhibitors Stephenson's 'Rocket' dating back to 1829 and the worlds fastest steam train, The Mallard, that travelled at 126mph, between London and Edinburgh.

The children will love the Jorvic Centre, the Viking city that was uncovered, when constructing the Coppergate Shopping Centre. You step aboard a time car for a journey that takes you into the Viking Age.

Shopping is a must, wonderful old narrow streets with quaint names such as the world famous, Shambles, Whip-ma-whop-ma Gate, Stone-Gate, Swinegate, Copper-gate etc.

To find some of the best seaside resorts, you are only one hour away from Scarborough, Bridlington, Whitby and more.

Approximately 50 miles from York is the old resort of Hornsea. Famous for its renowned pottery, you will find dinner and tea sets etc being made and you can buy at prices less than half of what you will pay in London for this famous mark.

For our full weeks visit we stayed at a lovely family run, licensed Hotel close to York race course, catering for individuals up to family rooms for adults and children, strongly recommended Field House, for details ring the owners, Ernie & Susan Wright on 01904 639572.

For our short break visits we always stay at the award winning guest house, The Bridge House, run by very friendly owners, Harry and Val Parker, telephone 01904 636161.

Next month, holidays in Malta.

p.s. I bet that Barbara Sugden and Hubby (she works in our staff restaurant) have a great time. She's visiting York in March.

Thamesmead welcomes back Mrs Bradley



Gregory Lomax, Thamesmead's Chief Executive, welcomed Mrs. Elizabeth Bradley back to Thamesmead at a Sanderling Court coffee morning on January 16th.

When they retired Mr. and Mrs. Bradley left Teeswater Court to return to their home town of Hartlepool, but when Mrs. Bradley was left alone following the sad loss of her husband, her greatest wish was to return to Thamesmead.

Mrs. Bradley's daughter called on elected director Ian Savill for advice. Ian directed her to Thamesmead Residential Lettings who were able to offer Mrs. Bradley a home in Sanderling Court where warden help is always on hand.

Thamesmead Town is delighted to welcome Mrs. Bradley back to Thamesmead.

THAMESMEAD TO CALAIS FOR JUST £12
9th OR 16th APRIL

le Shuttle

Lewis Coaches of Greenwich have joined together with the Thamesmead Times to offer Thamesmead residents a brilliant opportunity to visit Calais by travelling on *Le Shuttle.*

It's going to cost too much we hear you say, but no, Lewis Coaches have agreed to offer a special promotional price of just £12 per person.

Lewis's will pick you up from Thamesmead at 7.15am - you will travel by coach to and from Calais via Le Shuttle. They'll be 4 hours shopping in the new *Cite Europe Shopping Centre,* plus the opportunity of making the most of the benefits of the duty free at Le Shuttle terminal.

You should telephone Lewis's on 0181 858 0031 to book and to check your local pick up point.

WIN TWO FREE TICKETS

THE FIRST TWO TICKETS BOOKED FOR THE LE SHUTTLE TRIP WILL BE ABSOLUTELY FREE SO PICK UP THE 'PHONE AND MAKE THOSE BOOKINGS NOW!

0181 858 0031

ALIENS in the Dell?

If you see strange beings in unusual clothing in the the area called The Dell at Woolwich Garrison don't 'phone up the X files.

Due to land being contaminated during the war years from luminous paint products, the MOD using its contractor WasteChem are in the process of removing the contamination.

The MOD say that the levels of this substance existing in the area are very small and unlikely to represent a health hazard, however, out of respect for the environment and the general public all traces of this contamination must be removed.

Taking most of the year, areas will be fenced off to allow the contractors to carry out their work.

WIN

BACKSTAGE PASSES TO SEE J.X.

EQUINOX

The legendary J.X. will be appearing live at London's most exciting Disco on Saturday, 20th April.

To win a backstage pass all you have to do is 'phone the Equinox competition hotline on 0171 437 1446 and answer the following question:

NAME JX'S MOST FAMOUS CHART HIT SMASH FROM 1994/1995

THE CUTTY SARK



Located in the Town Centre
opposite the Clock Tower.
Linda, Peter and Staff welcome you.

Hot and Cold Food available
Monday to Friday Lunchtimes.
Cooked and prepared daily

Every Wednesday is Quiz Night.

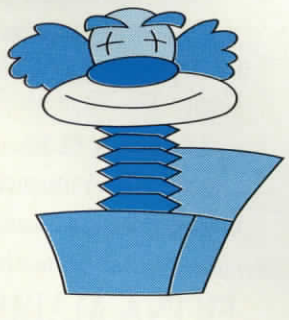
Weekend Entertainment

Parties welcome

please phone ahead to avoid disappointment

Telephone 0181 310 4998

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BETWEEN 9AM - 2PM
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AND A CHAT

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Ladies Hair and Beauty Salon

Introductory offer
Semi-permanent colour with Wash Cut and Blow Dry £12.00.
Special offer - Mini facial and Back massage £12.00

Hours: Mon, Tues, and Sat 9am-5pm
Wed 9am-12 noon
Thurs and Fri 9am-7pm
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22 Wilton Road, Abbey Wood, London SE2.

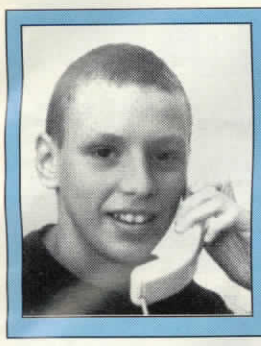
Telephone: 0181-311 3397

Thamesmead

Working with the Community



Harrow Manor Way, Thamesmead South, London SE2 9XH.
Tel: 0181-310 1500 Fax: 0181-310 1811



THE HARRIS REPORT

'Mead' back on form!

Thamesmead 2 Folkestone Invicta 1
Winstonlead Kent League
Tuesday 27th February

Thamesmead Town are back on form after a lengthy bout of the post-Vase blues. Since being knocked out of the competition by ICIS league Canvey Island the club had lost three league games out of four but an excellent win over 2nd placed Folkestone has put them back on track.

'Mead' got off to a dreadful start when a mistake from keeper Mitten gave Folkestone a 7th minute lead. However, this was to be short-lived thanks to Trevor Heseldon who equalised for the home side just before the break. He embarked on a solo run and chipped in the goal with a minimum of effort.

This set up an exciting second half which was made even more nailbiting when Dean Burns, the prolific striker who is making a name for himself around the Kent league, gave Thamesmead the lead with a good effort. Invicta piled on the pressure from here on in, looking at times like championship material.

The home side made several last gasp clearances towards the end of the tie but they did have a change to score a third when Heseldon hit the bar after a Thamesmead counter attack in the 91st minute. The result moves 'Mead' towards mid table as they eye yet another important cup encounter in the Kent Senior cup semi finals at home to Chatham in a couple of weeks.

Charlton's promotion challenge in the balance

A mixed bag of results followed by two defeats has left Charlton's promotion hopes well and truly in the balance. Losses of form at this time of the season are all too familiar to the Addicks, and defeats against the likes of Portsmouth and Southend must be prevented if they are even to retain a play off position come May.

The run of form has not come as a surprise to many supporters. The club has been involved in a backlog of league matches and earlier this month they were finally knocked out of the FA Cup by Premiership giants Liverpool. The relatively small squad are obviously in need of a break but at this time of the year the fixture list is as full as ever.

Another blow for Alan Curbishley's team is the loss of captain Keith Jones who, after fracturing a cheekbone, looks certain to be out for the remainder of the season. It seems it is up to the experience of players like Garry Nelson and Kim Grant to carry the young talent into the final stages.

At the time of writing Charlton are lying in third place, a healthy position by any clubs standards. They must now forget about their recent results and to coin a well known phrase 'take each game as it comes'. Automatic promotion to the Premier League can still be achieved!

THAMESMEAD COMMUNITY CAMPUS

Exhibitions
Workshops
Free Advice
Free Services
Free Creche
(1-3pm & 4-6pm)

Free entry
£50 Competition
& Prizes
Donated by
Thamesmead

WEDNESDAY
20th MARCH 1996
12 noon - 7pm

OPEN DAY

Refreshments available

THAMESMEAD COMMUNITY CAMPUS
YARNTON WAY THAMESMEAD

Greenmead U11's

Allen Gobbett cannot stop scoring goals at the moment. Having played right back for two seasons he was used as an emergency striker and has not looked back since.

He was on target again in our recent league match against Hayden Youth. In an end to end game, Gobbett ran onto a superb Sean Cross pass and kept his cool by slotting past the oncoming keeper. Although Hayden equalised midway through the second half we should have finished the match off by half time with the amount of changes we created. One all was the final result so at least we gained a point. The following week we had a Derby Cup match against A Division Crossways. Nick Carlton put us one up but the other team were level soon after the break. A good battling performance by the whole team saw us clinch the victory when Gobbett squeezed the ball home in the final minute of the match.

A great game and result. Well done lads.

Wayne Baldacchino
Greenmead U11's Manager

Successful Soccer

MORE SOCCER SUCCESS IN THE LOCAL AREA

Dartford Football clubs impressive football and ambitious approach merits a well earned mention. Local fans have enjoyed Thamesmead's run in the F.A. Vase and Charlton's promotion challenge this season, but they have also had the opportunity to attend Dartford's matches. The club, which has recently reformed, are playing at their neighbours, Erith & Belvedere's ground.

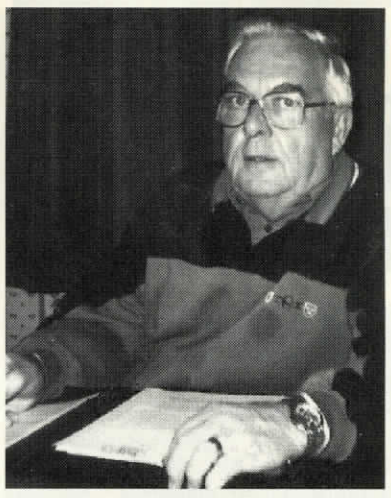
Throughout the 1980s the club were among the most well known in non league football, competing in the Beazer Homes Premier league and enjoying regular runs in the F.A. Trophy. Four figure crowds were a normality, as the club enjoyed their glory days at their huge Watling street stadium, which they shared with the ground owners Maidstone Utd.

Disaster struck when their landlords amassed huge debts eventually culminating in their bankruptcy, this inevitably also caused the sad disbandment of Dartford. It has been a long road back since those desperate days, but at last their seems to be light at the end of the tunnel.

Four years later and the club are on the brink of conquering the Kent league title which results in promotion to the Beazer southern division. One more step up from that and the 'Darts' will be back where they started in the Beazer Premier. What a wonderful achievement it would be!

Of course there are still problems. The search for their own ground being the biggest. Not that the local supporters are complaining, home games usually attract between four to five hundred, almost treble the Kent league's average attendance! The whole club deserve much praise for their on going determined efforts, and if they do go on to emulate past performances they only have themselves to thank.

Peter Harris



FISHING IN THE SOUTH-EAST.

by John Perkins.

Continuing on the theme of trying to get Anglers to
return to fishing our rivers where, due to efforts of the now defunct NRA, the water quality countrywide has improved beyond our expectations. Some rivers do still suffer from over abstraction, the most obvious in our area of course are the Darent, followed closely by the Kentish Stour. Clearly over the past Years where abstraction of vast quantities of water from the headwaters of rivers did considerable damage, causing many springs to fail. This further affected the small rivers, unless like the Tiese and Beult, flows are maintained by good sewage treatment works, or from being topped up by storage reservoirs. We must pressurise the water companies to take water into storage reservoirs, from the river in the winter at time of higher flows, and to make them wherever possible to abstract as near as possible to the mouth of rivers.

This Month I would like to extol the virtues of the River Beult. This tributary of the Medway, runs basically south of Maidstone, and joins the Medway at Yalding. It has been for many Years renowned for the quality of its fishing. Some pollution was experienced at times from two concerns involved in the production of dairy products, this situation happily has now been resolved. Such is the importance of this river, that the nineteen miles between Hadmans Place and Yalding, was a couple of Years ago, designated as a 'Site of Special scientific Interest' (SSSi). This means the area will be protected, and managed in such a way as to maintain the water quality and the environment, to the benefit of the fish and other wildlife.

On the Maidstone stretch there are some deep areas, which are very productive. Stick-Float and Pole tactics work well. Baits that work best are Sweetcorn, Bread, Red Maggot, and Bread. In addition to Maidstone Victory, ~here are many other clubs who control stretches, on this super river, they include, Dartford, Cranbrook, Bromley, L~A, Alders, Linton, and Headcorn.

In conclusion this Month, could I ask clubs to write in with details of any large concentration of Cormorants, we must get some more data together. As usual, I would be pleased to assist with any problems concerning Angling.

Tight Lines
John Perkins.
Contact me on ~01622)202 686.

Leap into Spring

If the thought of leaping around is less appealing – read on...This is where your local 'New Body' classes come in to help you combat that fear of the dreaded word 'EXERCISE'. These local fitness classes are designed for those of us who feel overweight and perhaps self conscious.

All newcomers are made to feel welcome as soon as they step through the front door, Fiona, the 'New Body' qualified class instructor will dispel your fears straight away. You will be asked about any conditions that may affect your ability to exercise, such as asthma or a bad back, and then you will be given advice about which exercises are safe for you to undertake.

The first 10-15 minutes consists of a gentle warm-up designed to get your body ready for the aerobic/cardio part of the class, this will increase your heart beat rate and burn calories aiding both fat and therefore weight loss!

The good news is that you don't have to leap around to get rid of all that fat, all you have to do is keep your body moving, for instance, marching on the spot. Now that doesn't sound too bad does it? Body Conditioning is next which can be performed either on the floor or still standing.



In a future issue of the Thamesmead Times, exercises and how to perform them with minimal effort will be looked at in more detail.

Give Fiona a call, she'll be happy to give you details of the local 'New Body' classes in Thamesmead and Abbey Wood.

Fiona can be reached on telephone number: 0181 312 0993.

FISHING IN MID-KENT

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Wednesdays 7pm to 8pm
The Village Hall, Goosander Way,
West Thamesmead

Thursdays 7.30pm-8.30pm
the Church of the Cross Hall,
Lensbury Way, Thamesmead

All sessions £2.50
by qualified RSA instructor

All levels of fitness welcomed.

For further information telephone:
FIONA MAIRS
0181-312 0993

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